# Proud to be a B

by Juniper Mariat



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# Proud to be a B

When I
stand up for myself
and my beliefs,
they call me a ...

When I
stand up for those
those I love,
they call me a ...

When I
speak my mind,
think my own thoughts,
or do things my own way…

I'm defined.

When I refuse
to tolerate
injustice and hate
They say
I am hysterical
PMS-ing
Delicate female
Overstressing

But I'm just tough
like rawhide
Knotted, stretched,
dried out and hardened
No predators want to use you
as a toy

I'm just tough
like the hollowed out hull of a
war ship
All cannons, no cargo
middle finger sails high in
the sky

I'm just tough like heavy
metal?
Like the stuff at the bottom of
the periodic table
Complex, rare, irradiated
and man-made

Tough like the mountains I've climbed to be seen
Tough like the scars I hide and the layers built up inside

Because life is such a…
And so am I, you say.

If you call me a b-word, then at least be creative.

Call me
Brazen for being loud
Buxom for being round
Brutish
Bratty
Breathless
Bulletproof
Ballsy by compare,
but Beware

Baptized in the fires of feminine repression,

obsession,
and progression
You can try to stomp,
stop,
or stunt me,
intimidate me
or frighten me.
douse my inner flame with more
handcuffs or hand granades
crush my spirit
or squash the beauty I hold within me.

But you won't succeed.

As women before me and beside me have proven
The soul of a woman doesn't crack
It's not the ball, it's the bat
It's the steady ready stance of a bull,
it's a trance
that keeps
you still
and safe.
Your soft parts erased.
Your demons replaced
With the hulking fire mouthed, steel scaled dragon that knights look at at say,
"Damn that's one tough..."

Because we ought to be.
Because we fought to be.

And if that makes me a bitch

so be it.

I embrace the title and I'm proud to stand up for myself, and my belief
Stand up for those, those I love
Speak my own thoughts, do things my own way
I'm proud to bear it.

Then call me a…
Then call me a…
Then call me a...